Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Thang is just back from a road trip in Queensland. Juliet wants to hear all about it.

Juliet: So, how was the road trip? Any drama?

Thang: Oh, you have no idea. **So there I was**, driving along the coast at night.

Juliet: Oh dear. I don't like where this is going.

Thang: **Out of nowhere**, something huge and hairy drops onto my shoulder.

Juliet: No way. Please tell me it wasn't a huntsman.

Thang: It was. **I thought to myself**, okay, stay calm, don't crash the car.

Juliet: Good call. So what did you do?

Thang: Pulled over, jumped out, slammed the door. Then **it hit me**. My phone was still inside.

Juliet: With the spider? Mate, you could've just shooed it out!

Thang: You weren't there! **I was like**, nope, that's its car now.

Study Notes

I don't like where this is going.
Nghe có vẻ không ổn rồi đây.
Phản ứng của người nghe khi đoán câu chuyện sắp có biến; giúp người kể thêm hào hứng.
Cách nói tương đương: This doesn't sound good.

Oh, you have no idea.
Ôi, cậu không tưởng tượng nổi đâu.
Câu mở màn trước khi kể một chuyện ly kỳ, khiến người nghe tò mò muốn nghe tiếp.
Cách nói tương đương: Where do I even start?

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. So there I was, driving along the coast at night.
linking: "there‿I", "coast‿at"
strong: "was", "coast", "night"

Giọng Mỹ nối /r/: "there I" → "đhe-rai". "was" cuối cụm đọc mạnh /wʌz/. Chậm lại và ngắt một nhịp sau "was" để tạo hồi hộp.

2. Out of nowhere, something huge and hairy drops onto my shoulder.
change: "Out‿of" (t → d nhẹ)
weak: "and", "my"
strong: "huge", "hairy", "shoulder"

"Out of" → "ao-đơv". Nhấn "huge", "hairy" và nói nhanh dần, như đang sống lại khoảnh khắc đó.

3. With the spider? Mate, you could've just shooed it out!
change: "could've" (have → "ơv")
linking: "shooed‿it‿out"
strong: "spider", "shooed"

"could've" → "cu-đơv"; "shooed it out" → "shu-đi-đao". Giọng Úc không đọc /r/ cuối "spider". Lên giọng ở "spider?" vì không tin nổi.

- Khi kể chuyện, chậm lại lúc dựng cảnh (So there I was…), rồi nói nhanh dần ở đoạn gay cấn.
- Ngắt một nhịp trước chi tiết bất ngờ: Then it hit me. (ngắt) My phone was still inside.
- "was" cuối cụm đọc mạnh /wʌz/; giữa câu đọc yếu /wəz/.
- Giọng Mỹ và giọng Úc đều hay đọc t giữa hai nguyên âm thành "d" nhẹ: out of, shooed it out.

Grammar Focus

Tạo hồi hộp: So there I was… / Out of nowhere… / Then it hit me

So there I was dựng cảnh; out of nowhere báo điều bất ngờ; then it hit me = chợt nhận ra. Có thể chuyển sang thì hiện tại cho sống động.

So there I was, stuck in a lift alone.
Out of nowhere, the lights went off.
Then it hit me. I'd left the oven on.

Kể lại suy nghĩ: I thought to myself… / I was like…

Thuật lại suy nghĩ, phản ứng như lời nói trực tiếp, không lùi thì. I was like… rất thân mật, chỉ dùng khi nói.

I thought to myself, this can't be happening.
He asked me to sing, and **I was like**, no way!

Role Play track 6

A: So, how was the road trip? Any drama?

B: Oh, you have no idea. So there I was, _____.

A: Oh dear. I don't like where this is going.

B: Out of nowhere, something huge and hairy drops onto my shoulder.

A: No way. Please tell me it wasn't a huntsman.

B: It was. I thought to myself, okay, _____, don't crash the car.

A: Good call. So what did you do?

B: Pulled over, jumped out, slammed the door. Then it hit me. My phone was still inside.

A: With the spider? Mate, you could've just shooed it out!

B: You weren't there! I was like, nope, _____.

Substitution Drill track 7

1. So there I was, <u>driving along the coast at night</u>.
   a. half asleep at the wheel
   b. miles from the nearest town
   c. singing along to the radio

2. I thought to myself, okay, <u>stay calm</u>, don't crash the car.
   a. deep breaths
   b. don't panic
   c. keep it together

3. I was like, nope, <u>that's its car now</u>.
   a. I'm walking home
   b. I'm not getting back in
   c. it can keep the car